

Editor's Note

It was raining throughout most of India but it didn't dampen the spirits of The Infravision Foundation (TIF). There was much action, as the team spread out to inform the world on various infrastructure issues. Many conversations were started and many ideas gained traction. The vision and mission for TIF are being further refined. Wish TIF luck.



TIF Reaches Out to Stakeholders

July was a month of connection and consolidation. From a meeting with Union Minister of Development of Northeastern Region to a consultation with key officials of the Odisha Government, from conversations with key members of NITI Aayog to a catch up with senior officials of L&T in Mumbai, Team TIF was out and about, working on collaborations. As has been said, alone we can do so little, together we can achieve so much.

[Connections and Conversations](#)[Rising Above Congestion](#)[TIF@Urban Affairs](#)[TIF@Media](#)[QUIZ](#)

Connections and Conversations

TIF CEO Jagan Shah and Head of Advocacy Kaveree Bamzai met powerhouse bureaucrat Anu Garg IAS, Chairperson, CRUT; Usha Padhee IAS, Principal Secretary, H&UD Dept, Odisha; and Dr. N Thirumala Naik IAS, MD – CRUT and Vice-Chair – BDA/MD – BSCL, to discuss the future of urban mobility in Odisha. Both Team Odisha and Team TIF agreed that urban and regional transport is the backbone of sustainable growth. Team TIF presented its studies and strategy planning exercises on the governance of urban and regional transport infrastructure, and innovations of the UMTA model. It noted that the regional plan for Bhubaneswar (BCPPER) is a unique opportunity to create a model for integrated transport systems that can be emulated by other states. It would build on the success of CRUT, which has renewed faith in well-planned bus and paratransit services. More on this soon.



TIF CEO Jagan Shah, TIF Advocacy Head Kaveree Bamzai, DC cum ACS and Chairperson CRUT Anu Garg IAS, Principal Secretary, H&UD Department, Government of Odisha, Usha Padhee IAS, Managing Director CRUT, Vice Chairman BDA and MD BSCL Dr N Thirumala Naik IAS.

TIF CEO Jagan Shah and Head Advocacy Kaveree Bamzai met Union Minister of Development of Northeastern Region Jyotiraditya Scindia in Delhi to present a report on unlocking horticulture production in Arunachal Pradesh by investing in infra and market access. The Minister gave a patient hearing to Team TIF and suggested solutions.

TIF Co-founder Rumjhum Chatterjee and TIF Head of Advocacy Kaveree Bamzai met L&T Wholetime Director DK Sen in Mumbai to talk about urban mobility and his corporation's experience in helping build new India as well as initiatives TIF is championing. Sen is also an advisor to TIF.

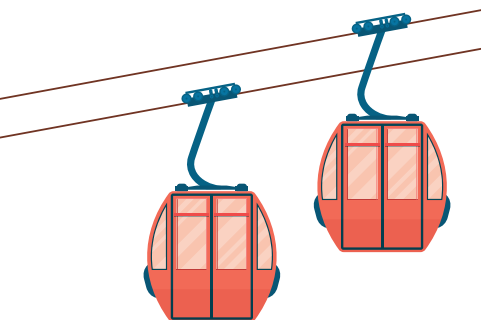


TIF CEO Jagan Shah, TIF Advocacy Head Kaveree Bamzai and Union Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia



TIF Head Advocacy Kaveree Bamzai, TIF Co-founder Rumjhum Chatterjee and L&T Wholetime Director DK Sen.

Rising Above Congestion



TIF's efforts at propagating ropeways as an urban transport solution made much headway. There was a front page ad on ropeways in Business Standard as well as a thought piece by TIF Head of Advocacy in Mint.

Rise above the crowds and the congestion

Urban ropeways: a new way to commute

Long bus rides. Crowded streets. Metro with poor last-mile connectivity. India's cities are demanding easy mobility. A new transportation system can make them more livable and sustainable. Urban ropeways are now being tested across Indian cities, offering a flexible, cost-effective and space-efficient answer to congestion, especially in dense and geographically challenged areas.

A recent study by The Infravision Foundation and DeC&A recommends launching a dedicated national programme under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHA) to mainstream urban ropeways.

Key proposals:

- Integrate ropeways into all City Mobility Plans (CMPs)
- Include ropeways for freight and passengers on the last-mile platform
- Fast-track approvals for projects that create jobs, cut carbon and ensure safety
- Encourage 'Made in India' ropeway technology

Let's build a greener, smarter urban future.

Join the conversation
Log onto the website
www.theinfravisionfoundation.org

The Infravision Foundation
Rethinking Infrastructure

ABOUT THE INFRAVISION FOUNDATION

- India's independent think-tank on infrastructure funds
- Championing appropriate infrastructure development initiatives for economic prosperity

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THEIR VIEW

Long haul: A national ropeway policy would aid urban mobility

This society's mode of transport can be integrated with transit systems to arrive urban commuters

Urban mobility and transportation are the backbone of a city's growth. India's cities are demanding easy mobility. A new transportation system can make them more livable and sustainable. Urban ropeways are now being tested across Indian cities, offering a flexible, cost-effective and space-efficient answer to congestion, especially in dense and geographically challenged areas.

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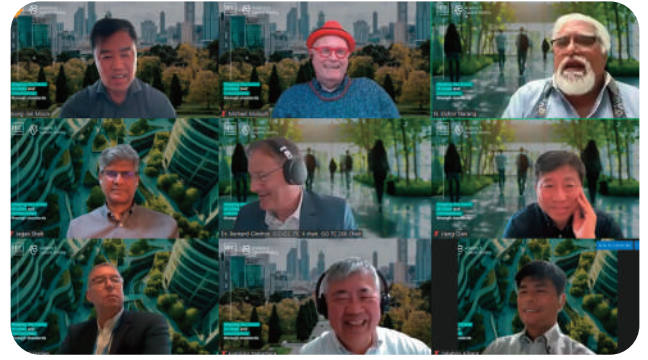
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TIF@Urban Affairs

TIF CEO Jagan Shah spoke on urban issues at two separate events this month. He spoke at a webinar on shaping the future of cities and communities through standards organised by the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) Academy. IEC, which is soon to be merged with the International Standards Organisation, plays a critical role in setting standards.

Shah also spoke at FICCI's Urban Challenge Summit & Urban Innovation Awards and was part of the jury for the awards.



Jagan Shah awarding the Aga Khan Agency for Habitat India in Green Buildings category at the 6th edition of Urban Innovations Awards.



Jagan Shah at the Panel Discussion at the Urban Challenge Summit & Urban Innovations Awards.

TIF Co-founder and Managing Trustee Rumjhum Chatterjee moderated the session, Realizing Women's Potential Through Closing the Gender Gap: Towards Women-Led Development, at the Gender Policy Symposium. Organised by the CII Centre for Women Leadership, it brought together leading voices to reimagine governance, growth, and gender equity. Those who spoke at the panel were Alliance for Global Good: Gender Equity and Equality Founder Smriti Irani; Member, Economic Advisory Council to the PM Shamika Ravi; NCAER Professor Ratna Sahay; World Bank Senior Economist Saumya Kapoor Mehta, and Deputy Resident Representative, UNDP India, Isabella Tschan.



TIF Co founder Rumjhum Chatterjee, Alliance for Global Good: Gender Equity and Equality Founder Smriti Irani; Member, Economic Advisory Council to the PM Shamika Ravi; Deputy Resident Representative, UNDP India, Isabella Tschan, NCAER Professor Ratna Sahay; and World Bank Senior Economist Saumya Kapoor Mehta



The search for InfraPandits got a boost when L&T decided to support TIF's unique initiative. Support from India's largest infrastructure company will undoubtedly help Young India in building New India.

TIF@Media

In his widely read column in Business Standard, TIF Founder and Managing Trustee Vinayak Chatterjee highlighted the reasons why the latest notification on dealing with emissions from coal-fired power plants deserves commendation.



The Case for Developing High-Speed Rail Corridors in India, authored by Dr TS Ramakrishnan, for TIF featured in Rail Business Magazine. The article outlines four priority corridors, advocates home-grown HSR tech and calls for a National HSR Tech Corporation.



Description	Corridor Description	Distance (km)	End-to-end Passengers 2036-37	
			Daily	Yearly
Main corridor 1	Delhi-Rewari-Jaipur-Ajmer-Jodhpur-Ahmedabad-(Mumbai)	934	2,09,315	7,63,99,976
Main corridor 2	Chennai-Mumbai via Tirupati, Bengaluru, Tumkur, Davangere, Dharwad, Belagavi, Kolhapur, Satara, Pune, Navi Mumbai with a spur to Goa	1,366	65,703	2,39,81,595
Main corridor 3	Delhi-Sonapat-Panipat-Karnal-Ambala-Chandigarh-Ludhiana-Jalandhar-Amritsar	665	49,116	1,79,28,975
Main corridor 4	Delhi-Agra-Lucknow-Varanasi-Patna-Kolkata	1,740	31,985	1,16,74,525
Total		4,705		

QUIZ: Test Your Infra Power

A note from a reader, TIF Trustee Kiran Karnik

One small correction: in glancing through (and seeking to test my knowledge!), I was dismayed to see that I was hugely off on one question in your June quiz: the distance from Navi Mumbai to Igatpuri. Having travelled sometime in that area (mainly by train), I was sure that the distance should be of the order of 150-200 km. Your answer indicates 700 km. I guess that is the total distance of the Expressway - from Mumbai to Nagpur. You may like to check - and correct, if possible.

TIF stands corrected.

- What is the name of the tunnel built in the Pir Panjal range by Alfred Kunz and C Barsel between 1954 and 1960, lauded then as an infrastructure marvel?
- This celebrated Indian author's father-in-law played a major role in building Delhi. Name the author.
- The two Danes went to the same school and then joined the same company: F L Smith and Co. The company sent one of them to India in 1933-1934 to set up a cement factory in Coimbatore. The other man joined in 1935. They set up a cement factory which later went on to be part of ACC. These men formed a partnership in 1938 and started importing and later manufacturing dairy equipment. Who were these gentlemen?
- Where was India's first steel plant located?
- How much does India need for investment in urban infrastructure by 2050?



- Jawahar Tunnel
- Khushwant Singh, and his father in law was chief engineer of CPWD, Sardar Bahadur Teja Singh Malik.
- Henning Holck-Larsen and Soren K Toubro, known later as L&T.
- India's first steel plant was established in Jamshedpur, Jharkhand. It was the Tata Iron and Steel Company (TISCO), founded by Jamsetji Tata in 1907.
- According to the World Bank, India needs \$2.4 trillion by 2050 for urban infrastructure to support a growing urban population, potentially reaching \$10.9 trillion by 2070.



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